



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

yo yo varṇo 'vahīyeta yo vodrekam anuvrajet | 18.006a
taṁ taṁ dr̥ṣṭvā svato mārgāt pracyutaṁ sthāpayet pathi || 6 || 18.006c
aśāstrokteṣu cānyeṣu pāpayukteṣu karmasu | 18.007a
prasamīkṣyātmano rājā daṇḍaṁ daṇḍyeṣu pātayet || 7 || 18.007c

— Nāradaśmṛti, Chapter 17, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This passage from the Narada Smriti addresses the vital role of leadership, both within ourselves and in society, in maintaining dharma, the righteous order. It speaks of those who stray from their prescribed path, whether through transgression or elevation beyond their capacity, and the responsibility to guide them back to balance. It also discusses the king's duty to administer justice, particularly in cases not explicitly covered by scripture, ensuring that wrongdoing is met with appropriate consequences.

The core message here is about maintaining equilibrium. Imagine society as a tapestry, where each thread, representing an individual and their prescribed role, contributes to the overall beauty and strength. When a thread frays or becomes entangled, the tapestry weakens. This verse urges us to observe when individuals deviate from their dharma, not with judgment, but with a desire to restore harmony. This isn't about rigid enforcement of social hierarchy; it's about recognizing individual potential and guiding people toward fulfilling their unique purpose within the larger societal context.

The king's role in administering justice, even in unscripted situations, highlights the importance of discerning right from wrong. It emphasizes the need for wisdom and careful consideration when dealing with complex moral dilemmas. The king, symbolizing leadership, must use their power to uphold dharma and protect the vulnerable.

In modern life, this wisdom translates to self-awareness and compassionate leadership. We must be vigilant in observing our own tendencies to stray from our chosen path, whether through negative habits or inflated egos. We also have a responsibility to guide others, offering support and wisdom when they falter. Leadership isn't limited to formal positions; it's about taking responsibility for the well-being of our communities and upholding ethical principles in our daily lives. The king's duty becomes our duty: to discern right from wrong and to act in accordance with dharma, creating a more just and harmonious world.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

In what ways can you better recognize when you or others are straying from your path, and how can you offer guidance with compassion and wisdom, rather than judgment?